

NICHOLAS N. RAY

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Updated March 2026

Education

Texas A&M University

August 2021 -

Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science

Anticipated Dissertation Defense Date: **Spring 2026**

Committee: William Clark (chair), Quan Li, Scott Cook, Thomas Flaherty, and Raymond Robertson

University of South Carolina

December 2020

Bachelor of Arts, Political Science and Economics

Publications

Book Chapters

Dunaway, Johanna and Nicholas Ray. 2023. “[Communication Technology and Threats to Democracy: We Are \(Also\) the Problem.](#)” In *News Quality in the Digital Age*, edited by Regina Lawrence and Philip Napoli. New York: Routledge.

Working Papers

Ray, Nicholas. 2026. “[Explaining Compensation Failure: Trade, Partisan Collusion, and the Underprovision of Compensation.](#)” Under review at *International Studies Quarterly*.

Works in Progress

Ray, Nicholas. 2026. “[Estimating Compensation Failure: How Much Has Compensation Been Underprovided?](#)”

Ray, Nicholas and Erik Chi. 2026. “[ADiDL: Improving Difference-in-Differences \(DiD\) Estimators by Incorporating Dynamics.](#)”

Grants and Awards

Heep Graduate Fellowship Award (\$30,000)

January 2025 - December 2025

[Hagler Institute for Advanced Study at Texas A&M](#) with [Hagler Fellow Dr. Beth Simmons](#)

Conference Presentations

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)

2026

Panel: “International Trade and Social Goods: Social Impact of Trade Agreements.”

Paper: “Estimating Compensation Failure: How Much Has Compensation Been Underprovided?”

2025

Panel: “International Trade: Coalitions, Complexity, and Compensation.”

Paper: “Explaining Compensation Failure: Trade, Partisan Collusion, and the Underprovision of Compensation.”

American Political Science Association (APSA)

2026

Poster Session: “New Directions in International Political Economy”

Paper: “Estimating Compensation Failure: How Much Has Compensation Been Underprovided?”

2024

Panel: “Graduate Students in International Political Economy” (GSIPE) Pre-Conference Workshop

Paper: “Explaining Compensation Failure: Trade, Partisan Collusion, and the Underprovision of Compensation.”

Teaching

Instructor of Record

[Globalization and Democracy](#) (POLS 328)

Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

Texas A&M University

[Ordinary Least Squares](#) (POLS 602)

Fall 2024, Fall 2023

[Maximum Likelihood Estimation](#) (POLS 603)

Spring 2024

[Introduction to Research Methods](#) (POLS 209)

Spring 2023

Introduction to Political Science (POLS 200)	Fall 2022, Spring 2022, Fall 2021
ICPSR (University of Michigan)	
Methods and Models for Time Series Data Analysis	Summer 2024
Panel Data	Summer 2025
Panel Data	Summer 2026